



BIOCARBON PARTNERS

Investing In African Communities & Forests



Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) concerning Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)

Upholding Local
Community Rights

Version 4: March 2013

IP and background info

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About BioCarbon Partners (BCP)

BCP is a dynamic African-based and headquartered social enterprise dedicated to REDD+ project development and management. BCP's vision, as a majority African-citizen owned company, is to ensure that the majority of benefits coming from African forests are retained within Africa. BCP's mission is to reduce poverty and to enhance conservation through emissions reductions and avoided deforestation projects. BCP's hallmarks are its focus on dryland forest REDD+ projects in Africa, as well as its local presence and expertise. BCP has an experienced team of African conservationists with vast experience throughout the continent in forest carbon project implementation.

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Finally, BCP would like to thank all of the "community stakeholders" whose patience and support of our work has allowed us to launch the first pilot REDD+ project—the Lower Zambezi REDD+ Project—in Zambia. Our experiences and interactions with these communities have informed the guidelines and strategies set out in our SOP documents.

Introduction

As a social enterprise that endeavours to launch REDD+ projects that simultaneously protect forests and achieve additional community benefits, BioCarbon Partners (BCP) is committed to following the principles of obtaining Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC), and engaging in a rigorous Social Monitoring Program. This Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) handbook outlines BCP's policies insofar as they concern informing communities about REDD+ projects and obtaining communities' consent to participate in such projects. BCP's *Social Monitoring Program SOP* is a separate document that describes the company's policies concerning monitoring and evaluating the impacts that these projects have on communities—particularly on their livelihoods and land-use patterns.

Defining Free, Prior and Informed Consent (FPIC)¹

The principle of obtaining “Free, Prior and Informed Consent” (FPIC) refers to the right of communities “to give or withhold their consent to proposed projects that may affect the lands they customarily own, occupy or otherwise use.”² The principles of FPIC recognize the right of local communities to be involved in decision-making about the lands that they customarily use.

The following sections provide a brief overview of the terms relevant to FPIC, including their definitions and interpretations, and their relevance for the implementation of REDD project activities.

Free

“Free” refers to consent that has been obtained from communities without force, coercion, intimidation, or pressure from any actor. It also refers to the collective right of communities to make decisions for themselves, without facing any threat or fear of retaliation if they decide to say “no.”

BCP can ensure to obtain “Free” consent by:

- Coordinating community meetings at mutually agreed locations and times;
- Ensuring that persons who are considered to be threatening or coercive³ by either side are not in attendance at these meetings;
- Expressing BCP's commitment not to implement any REDD project activities without community consent;
- Informing communities that they have the right to negotiate or refuse any conditions of REDD project agreements;
- Ensuring that communities are given adequate time to consider information and make decisions;
- Allowing community stakeholders to set time-lines for decision-making processes, and to determine the amount of time that is necessary for them to make decisions;
- Ensuring that external facilitators or implementers are competent and neutral;
- Seeking independent validation and verification processes that confirm that community decisions were made without coercion or threats;
- Seeking competent third party assistance (including legal assistance) if negotiations break down;
- Ensuring that sufficient time has passed when re-requesting consent, if consent has already been denied.

¹ See: Edwards, K., Triraganon, R., Silori, C. and Stephenson, J. (2012). *Putting Free, Prior, and Informed Consent into Practice in REDD+ Initiatives: A Training Manual*. RECOFTC, IGES and Norad, Bangkok, Thailand. viii + 184 pages.

² Forest Peoples Program (FPP) website: <http://www.forestpeoples.org/guiding-principles/free-prior-and-informed-consent-fpic>

³ “Threatening or coercive” refers to behavior that causes either side to feel as though they are in danger of incurring any sort of harm or negative repercussions if they do not comply with the desires of the threatening or coercive party.

Prior

“Prior” refers to consent that has been sought in advance of any authorization or decision-making related to the implementation of REDD project activities. This is important in that it allows communities sufficient time to analyze and seek additional information concerning REDD and relevant issues, so that they can make fully informed decisions. For the purposes of launching a REDD project, it is important that BCP seeks community consent from the beginning of the REDD feasibility process, and throughout all stages of the REDD implementation process. BCP expects the principles of FPIC to guide our on-going community consultation and engagement processes.

Informed

“Informed” refers to consent that has been obtained through the full disclosure of all relevant information, including all stakeholder perspectives, and which has been provided in appropriate languages and formats. Informed consent must be obtained through the active participation of all community members, and should reflect a clear understanding of the facts, implications and potential future consequences of such decisions. Individuals can only provide informed consent where they are in possession of all relevant facts at the time that consent is given.

In terms of REDD project implementation, it is important that all people whose livelihoods and wellbeing could be impacted by a REDD project are fully informed of the facts and potential consequences of their consent to the project.

In order to ensure compliance with the principle of obtaining “Informed” consent, BCP should ensure that:

- Information is available in local languages, and meetings are held in appropriate local languages;
- Information is provided in simple forms of communication that are easily understood;
- Information is transmitted in culturally appropriate ways;
- Face-to-face meetings and participatory methods are used wherever possible, to ensure direct communication of correct information;
- Information is disseminated as widely as possible;
- Communities possess an adequate understanding of technical information and agreements concerning rights (such as carbon or land-use rights);
- Communication methods are regularly assessed and verified for their effectiveness

It is especially important that Individuals and community members are provided with adequate **information about REDD projects** and they are **informed of their right to give or deny consent**. They should also be informed that they have the right to seek independent expert advice on relevant legal, social, economic, and environmental issues, prior to providing their consent.

Consent

“Consent” that has been obtained in compliance with the principles of FPIC entails that the community has made a full and clear agreement to the terms of the proposed REDD project. It is essential that communities are aware of their right to either approve or reject the terms of the project, and that they do not feel coerced or threatened into any decision concerning their provision of consent. The principles of FPIC require that communities are informed and well aware of their right to say “yes” or “no” to the REDD project at any stage, in accordance with their own decision-making processes.

It is important to remember that “consent” represents a contract between two or more parties. As such, it is important that the parties to this “contract” share a mutual understanding of its terms. In order to obtain full consent in line with the principles of FPIC, it is necessary for all relevant persons in a community—all those who are reasonably expected to be affected by the implementation of a REDD project—are fully

involved and participate in the decision-making processes concerning consent. BCP engages in a rigorous multi-stakeholder consultation and engagement process, so as to identify appropriate stakeholders who must be targeted for consultation and consent pertaining to each Agreement or Contract that is to be made concerning REDD-related activities. BCP relies heavily on its Community Engagement Team and relevant local community engagement institutions (such as traditional leaders, village committees and BCP-supported “Zone Development Committees”) to identify appropriate stakeholders for each consultation and engagement process. It is BCP’s responsibility to ensure that information concerning REDD projects is provided to all stakeholders within a community, and that their consent is fully and freely obtained prior to the implementation of REDD project activities.

In all of BCP’s operations, written contracts (in the form of “Community Covenants”) will document the terms of any agreements that have been made between BCP and local communities, following an appropriate process of consultation and decision-making in line with the principles of FPIC.

BCP and the Principles of FPIC

In line with its commitment to achieve positive social and community benefits as part of its forest protection projects, BCP has adopted the principles of FPIC and has incorporated them into its SOPs concerning project implementation, emphasizing the value that BCP places on working in partnership with local communities. As such, BCP aims to:

1. Engage in a comprehensive multi-stakeholder consultation and engagement process that includes as many members of local communities as possible in decision-making, and to make a determined effort to include more vulnerable and marginalized groups;
2. Provide people with key information about BCP’s projects in ways that are easy to understand and locally-appropriate (including: providing information in relevant local languages);
3. Be careful not to raise expectations—particularly with regard to carbon finance—given the uncertainties that currently surround REDD;
4. Ensure that local communities understand that they have the opportunity to accept or reject proposed projects;
5. Ensure that local communities understand that their participation in projects is **voluntary**:
 - a. At no point will any BCP employee show any kind of threatening or coercive behaviour⁴
6. Guarantee that no bribes will be paid by any BCP employee;
7. Consult with and inform the government:
 - a. In some cases, government officials have no resources for fuel or transport, so allowances need to be considered in order to engage government officials in meetings. Governments have published allowance rates for half-day and night-out activities, and if the Government insists that BCP must pay these, BCP will record and document all allowances that are paid, in the interest of ensuring transparency
8. Encourage **adaptive management** based on community input about projects—it is essential that all agreements are negotiated and agreed upon by all parties involved.

BCP recognizes that FPIC is an on-going, participatory process that entails regular communication and effective consultation between BCP and local community stakeholders, and on-going negotiations concerning the terms of REDD-related agreements.

⁴ Local communities are expected and allowed to determine what behaviors constitute “threatening or coercive”—in the event that they feel such behavior has taken place, they are encouraged to follow BCP’s “Grievance Mechanism” procedures, or to directly contact relevant Third Party arbitrators, such as legal counsel.

Demonstrating FPIC Compliance:

In order to demonstrate that BCP has complied with the principles of FPIC, BCP aims to collect the following forms of documentation:

1. Records that show that a **minimum of 51% of all stakeholders have been informed and consulted prior** to the implementation of a REDD+ project or related project activities:
 - a. **“Stakeholders”** include all those whose livelihoods are reasonably expected to be impacted by a deforestation mitigation project. Essentially, those whose livelihoods are dependent—either in whole or in part—on activities that result in permanent deforestation are considered to be stakeholders in a REDD+ project.
 - b. BCP engages in community mapping and community census processes, in order to ensure that it has adequately accounted for and engaged all potential stakeholders (please see BCP’s *SOP Concerning Community Engagement*).
 - i. BCP relies heavily on community input and local knowledge in the stakeholder-identification process.
 - ii. During the community mapping process, BCP will identify traditional decision-making structures and processes.
 - iii. BCP will work through local institutions to determine the most appropriate community consultation methods to employ throughout its consultation, engagement and decision-making processes, including the identification of appropriate representatives to make decisions on behalf of community stakeholders (ie: those individuals or groups who may be involved in writing and signing Community Covenants)
 - c. Census information should be compared with consultation/sensitization records, to ensure and document that a minimum of 51% of stakeholders have been informed and consulted prior to the implementation of a REDD+ project.
 - d. BCP aims for a minimum 51% consultation rate, in order to demonstrate that the majority of community stakeholders have been effectively involved in our multi-stakeholder consultation and engagement process.
2. **Signed minutes** documenting the content/information that was presented at each community consultation/sensitization meeting, as well as the attendance at each community meeting (See: *Appendix 1*);
 - a. The meeting minutes must be signed by community representatives, confirming their accuracy and legitimacy.
 - b. The meeting minutes should be dated, and should demonstrate that the community information/consultation process took place prior to project implementation.
 - c. The record of meeting minutes should demonstrate that:
 - i. Sufficient information was presented so as to allow communities to make an informed decision, including facts about projects and potential consequences (please see *Appendix 1* for the Community Meeting Minutes template, which includes an outline of general information to be presented concerning REDD);
 - ii. Meetings took place prior to project implementation, and allowed communities sufficient time (as agreed between BCP and the community) to consider the implications of their decision to consent;
 - iii. Attendance records should confirm that there was no one present at these meetings that could be considered, by either side, to be threatening or coercive, such that consent is considered to have been given freely;
 - iv. Similarly, meeting records should document that community stakeholders were informed of their right to approve or deny the REDD-related project, without facing real or implied threats of retaliation for their decision either way

1. It should be emphasized that the decision to support BCP in launching a REDD+ project, or related projects, is *voluntary*, and that BCP will not launch any REDD+ project or related projects without the consent of local stakeholders.
- d. The complete set of documentation concerning consultation/sensitization meetings held by BCP should demonstrate that BCP made every effort possible to make information available to all stakeholders
 - i. It should be demonstrated that BCP held meetings in central locations that were easily accessible for all stakeholders;
 - ii. It should be demonstrated that BCP made efforts to reach out to stakeholders who were not attending meetings;
 - iii. Records should indicate that BCP made information available in local languages, and that information was presented in culturally appropriate mediums, such that community stakeholders were able to fully understand the information that was presented
- e. Minutes should document that community members were asked to vote for or against the implementation of a REDD+ project, and should clearly list the results of the vote.
 - i. Votes take place once the community stakeholders determine that enough information has been presented for them to make an informed decision about consent—this may occur after one meeting, or after multiple meetings, as determined by the local community members who are concerned in the decision-making process.
- f. **The complete set of records documenting community meetings and approval ratings (from votes held during the meetings) should demonstrate that a minimum of 51% of all stakeholders were fully informed and consulted prior to project implementation, and that a minimum of 75% of those consulted freely consented to the implementation of a REDD+ project or related activities.**
- g. BCP recognizes that FPIC is an on-going, participatory process that entails regular communication and effective consultation between BCP and local community stakeholders, and on-going negotiations concerning the terms of REDD-related agreements. As such, BCP conducts regular consultation and sensitization meetings concerning BCP's REDD+ projects and related activities, as part of our adaptive project management strategy that is designed to ensure that community benefits are consistent and community consent is regularly maintained.
 - i. BCP will continue to consult and engage the same stakeholders throughout the life of any given REDD+ project or related activities.
 - ii. At a minimum, stakeholders in any given project activity will be consulted once every two years, for the purposes of engaging in Social Monitoring and to ensure on-going compliance with the principles of FPIC.
 - iii. BCP will continue to endeavour to maintain a minimum 51% consultation/sensitization rate among stakeholders, and to achieve a minimum 75% approval rate among these stakeholders.
 - iv. Consultation and consent rates will be documented throughout the life of the projects that BCP launches.
3. Letters of Consent
 - a. BCP will additionally request that all relevant representatives of community stakeholders (such as Headmen, Headwomen of Chiefs responsible for communities living within the Project Zone for a REDD+ project) provide signed letters of consent documenting their approval of a community-based decision to support a REDD+ project or related activities.
4. Documented consultation and approval rates from Surveys
 - a. As part of BCP's on-going Social Monitoring Program, BCP will engage in routine rounds of surveys to assess the socio-economic conditions faced by community

stakeholders for its REDD+ project(s) (See BCP's *Social Monitoring Program SOP* for more information on this program or the surveys);

- b. Each survey conducted will ask respondents to state whether or not they consent to the implementation of a REDD+ project;
- c. In combination with records kept concerning community sensitization meetings and approval rates during those meetings, data collected from BCP's surveys as part of the on-going Social Monitoring Program should continue to demonstrate a minimum 51% consultation rate among community stakeholders, and a minimum 75% approval rating for the implementation (or continuation) of a REDD+ project or related activities.
- d. In the event that the community approval rate for a REDD-related project drops below 75%, BCP will engage in a thorough consultation and engagement process with stakeholders to determine necessary amendments or revisions to project-design or implementation strategies, so as to ensure that community approval for a project is maintained. This is reflective of BCP's adaptive management strategy concerning its project design and implementation processes, which requires BCP to engage in on-going negotiations with local community stakeholders concerning appropriate project design and implementation efforts. The (changing) terms of these agreements will be documented in the form of written contracts ("community covenants") between BCP and local community stakeholders.
 - i. If, at any time, community stakeholders identify that they have concerns or grievances concerning BCP's project-implementation, they are encouraged to engage BCP's Grievance Mechanism—which is managed by BCP at a low (initial) level, and includes addressing concerns to a Third Party negotiator in the event that BCP is unable to resolve any remaining issues. The details of BCP's Grievance Mechanism are explained to community members during every community consultation/sensitization meeting, using appropriate mediums (including appropriate local languages). BCP's Grievance Mechanism is described in greater detail in our *Community Engagement Strategy SOP*.

5. Community Covenants for Community Projects

- a. For every community-level intervention⁵ that it launches, a Community Covenant must be signed by relevant community stakeholders or representatives and BCP representatives.
- b. A Community Covenant is a written contract that documents the terms of agreements that have been made between BCP and local stakeholders, following a thorough community stakeholder consultation and engagement process.
 - i. Prior consultation and agreements with community stakeholders will determine *who* can enter into agreements, such as Community Covenants, on behalf of the community, and the time-frame that is appropriate for entering into such decisions
- c. Each Community Covenant must document that community stakeholders:
 - i. Have been thoroughly consulted and engaged in the decision-making process concerning project design and implementation;
 - ii. Understand whatever terms of the **agreement** to launch the project they must adhere to;
 - iii. Understand that their decision to support or participate in the project is voluntary;
 - iv. Clearly and freely consent to the implementation of the project.

⁵ "Community-level interventions" include REDD-related projects that affect stakeholder livelihoods, including community-based deforestation mitigation activities that are designed to improve livelihoods and reduce local deforestation.

BCP's overall Community Engagement Strategy is elaborated in further detail in our *SOP Concerning Community Engagement*. An outline of the steps involved in our Community Consultation and Engagement Process is attached in *Appendix 2*.

Conclusions

BCP aims to be able to demonstrate its compliance with the principles of FPIC throughout every stage of the REDD implementation process. BCP is a social enterprise whose goal is to ***make forest protection beneficial for local people***. It is important that BCP's rigorous standards for environmental protection are taken into consideration along with the social and human development impacts of the company's projects. BCP approaches forest protection and deforestation mitigation projects through agreements and **partnerships** with local communities. As such, the principles of FPIC are closely linked to the core values of BCP, which include putting local communities as the heart of the company's avoided deforestation/REDD projects.

Appendix 1: Minutes Templates



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Investing In African Communities & Forests

Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) meeting minutes

REGION

Date: yyyy/mm/dd BCP employee: First and Last Name Chaired by:

Villages Represented:

Attendance: male and female

Photo

Program

- Beginning prayer
- Welcome remarks given by Chairman/Chairwoman
- BCP community engagement coordinator introduces themselves, their fellow colleagues, and BCP
- BCP members give a presentation on BCP and on REDD projects and the talk about the role of the community in the process. Questions can be asked throughout the presentation.
- Q&A
- Vote
- Closing Remarks
- Closing Prayer

Introduction

As part of the introduction a handout with basic information on BCP, global warming, and REDD was handed out. The community representatives present were encouraged to share it with those who were unable to make the meeting, and it was pointed out that BCP's contact info was included on the back panel. After BCP was introduced BCP members explained the important information of REDD projects.

Key points of REDD projects shared

- BioCarbon Partners is a social enterprise which deals in the forest carbon market through Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) projects. Its mission is to reduce poverty and enhance forest protection in partnership with local communities. BCP is also working in collaboration with partners such as NGOs and UN supported agencies.
- Introduction to REDD and how it is implemented
 - What is permanence, how it relates to REDD, what it means for the community (30 years)
 - REDD projects target the private, communal, and preserved areas

- REDD project does not require land title deeds from any landowner; they only agree to put their forests into the project.
- That the people in the communities have the opportunity to accept or reject the project.
- That this entire project is voluntary
- The roles and responsibilities of everyone
- The community has the right to seek independent expert advice on legal, social, economic, and environmental issues.
- If this project is accepted on village lands then a contract will be signed by the headman or Chief which will permits BCP and the community to jointly look after the designated forests and accrue benefits from keeping trees alive through the carbon markets.
- That BCP will share information from the feasibility study to provide further information and consent for the next steps.
- That by participating in a process where their rights to land/resources are not legally recognized nationally, i.e., decisions may not be upheld or subject to recourse
- That if they have any questions or concerns to feel free to contact any of the members whose contact info was given on the back panel of the brochure handed out
- Basic Information on Global Warming (Climate Change) and how it relates to REDD projects
- It was explained that the immediate benefits to the community would be the creation of jobs such as security positions for protecting the forests. It was then explained that some other benefits down the road would be the potential of projects being implemented in the area. BioCarbon Partners and the community would collaborate on deciding what projects would be viable and would have the most impact in the area. It was then explained that this project was one of many REDD projects all over the world, and that REDD is one of the multitudes of initiatives around the globe that are fighting climate change.
- Description of BCP's contact information and Grievance Mechanism procedures—*contact information is provided on BCP's Community Brochures, which are made available in local languages.*

Currently

- [Enter updates about BCP's relevant project-related activities]

Q&A

Question: Enter question

Answer: Enter given answer

Vote

After the Q&A a vote was held. The community was asked if they gave consent to BioCarbon Partners doing a feasibility study in the area. The results were

FOR: xx OPPOSED: xx

Closing Remarks and Closing Prayer

Signatures

By signing these minutes you are agreeing that these minutes are an accurate recount of the meeting that happened on DATE in AREA. You are also agreeing that at no point has a BioCarbon Partners employee shown any kind of coercion in convincing you to make any decisions. You are also agreeing that BioCarbon Partners has not paid anyone to attend the meetings, or to sign this document.

BioCarbon Partners

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Community Attendee

Name: _____

Signature _____

Date _____

Witness

Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Appendix 2: Community Consultation and Engagement process

BCP COMMUNITY STAKEHOLDER CONSULTATION and ENGAGEMENT PROCESS, IN LINE WITH FPIC:

1) Initial stakeholder community mapping	2) Initial stakeholder consultation/sensitization	3) Project Design and Implementation	4) Ongoing consultation, negotiation of terms and adaptive management
. Identify local institutions and decision-making structures . Involve local institutions and leaders in stakeholder identification and mapping processes (to benefit from local knowledge and legitimacy) . Obtain accurate census information . Obtain reflective, accurate baseline socio-economic information, to better understand communities	. Work with local community institutions, leaders and representatives to determine appropriate consultation schedules and methods of information-sharing (including: when and where to meet, appropriate languages and instruction models) . Work with communities to identify stakeholders and to determine whose consent must be obtained prior to project implementation . Ensure stakeholders are fully informed, by providing detailed information about project aims, designs and potential consequences . Seek <u>consent</u> from community stakeholders <u>prior</u> to implementation of project activities . Ensure consent is given freely from relevant stakeholders (no threats or coercion) . Rely on communities to determine the consultation and decision-making process, including: when effective consultation has been achieved, when they have had enough time to make decisions to give consent, and who should be involved in decision-making processes. . Information and decisions will be documented in signed meeting minutes	. Community-based decision process that relies heavily on involving and working with local institutions and leaders, that have been identified (by local communities) as the appropriate representatives to work with . Establish locally-based decision-making bodies (such as BCP's innovative, hybridized "Zone Development Committee (ZDC)" structures) . Incorporate local knowledge into information sharing and decision-making processes . Ensure decisions are made with local legitimacy (ie: appropriate, community-supported representatives have been involved in and consented to project design and implementation processes) . Engage in widespread multi-stakeholder consultation and incorporate local feedback into project design . Terms of agreements are documented in signed "Community Covenants" that list rights and responsibilities of local community stakeholders as well as BCP	. FPIC is an ongoing process that involves regular consultation and engagement of local communities in decision-making processes . Routine reassessment of community support/consent. . Adaptive management strategies incorporate community feedback into project implementation, management and design . Terms of agreements re-negotiated with communities as needs arise and change; new "Community Covenants" signed to ensure recognition . Use of Third-Party mediated Grievance Mechanism, in the event that conflicts arise that BCP cannot resolve . BCP places all key information in the public domain to enhance transparency and accountability

Appendix 3: Community Informational Brochure

BCP's Community Informational Brochure is provided to local community stakeholders at all BCP consultation/sensitization meetings, and additional copies are made available to communities upon request. The information presented at BCP's community consultation/sensitization meetings is described in greater detail in our *SOP Concerning Community Engagement*, and is further elaborated in our BCP Community Engagement Team (CET) Training curriculum, which is made available upon request. BCP relies heavily on engaging informational sessions that are led by skilled facilitators in local languages, due to the high rate of illiteracy among local community stakeholders. We additionally have an informational cartoon that provides a clear, simple illustration of BCP's REDD+ project implementation process, which is used to help facilitate understanding of REDD processes among illiterate community stakeholders (See *Appendix 4*).

During community consultation/sensitization sessions, BCP's Grievance Mechanism is described to local communities. Community members are additionally encouraged to contact BCP using the contact information provided (which is listed on this brochure) should they have any questions, concerns or complaints about BCP's involvement.

BCP's Community Informational Brochure is made available in local languages, including Nyanja.



BIOCARBON PARTNERS
Investing In African Communities & Forests

BioCarbon Partners (BCP) is an African-headquartered and majority African-owned social enterprise that develops and manages long-term forest carbon projects in globally biodiversity significant landscapes in Africa. Our goal is to maximize the benefits of African forests within Africa. We believe that Africa has the talent and capacity to be a global leader in the Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Degradation (REDD) sector.

BioCarbon Partners is a social enterprise. Our mission puts poverty reduction and conservation first, but in a financially sustainable way. Our hybrid business model includes an efficient, lean commercial structure to sell and market credits, and a grassroots model that targets social and environmental impact at a community level.

Our MISSION:

To forge global partnerships in order to reduce poverty, and enhance conservation through global carbon markets.

Our VISION:

To achieve transformational social development and conservation returns in Africa through REDD

Please feel free to contact us with any questions or concerns.

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Email: mainecy.hampeyo@gmail.com

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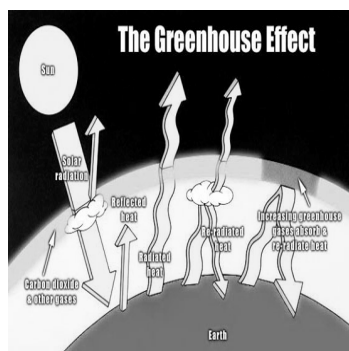
REDD+ BACKGROUND INFORMATION

PACHIYAMBI CHA REDD+



What is Climate Change

Since the late 19th century, average global temperatures of the Earth's atmosphere and oceans have been rising—and they are expected to continue to do so. Since the early 20th century, Earth's average surface temperature has increased by about 0.8 °C, with about two thirds of the increase occurring since 1980. This phenomenon is often referred to **"global warming,"** although the worldwide effects of global climate change have more varied than simply rising temperatures. Rising average global temperatures have resulted in less predictable and more extreme weather patterns—for example, unpredictable rainfall patterns, droughts, and extreme storms. These processes of global warming and climate change are caused by increasing concentrations of **greenhouse gases** produced by human **activities** such as **deforestation and the burning of fossil fuels** for energy transport and factories.



Source <http://www.dinosaurfact.net/extinction/greenhouseeffect.php>

What is REDD+

REDD+ stands for Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and forest Degradation, and includes the conservation of indigenous forests, sustainable management of forests, and enhancement of forest carbon stocks.

Deforestation and forest degradation contribute approximately 20% of global anthropogenic greenhouse gas emissions. The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) is developing the REDD+ mechanism to provide financial incentives to reduce such emissions, in an effort to mitigate the effects of global climate change.

Zambia has about 50 million hectares of forest, with an estimated deforestation rate of 250,000 to 300,000 hectares annually. Primary drivers of deforestation and forest degradation need to be addressed in order to ensure the success of REDD+ projects in Zambia. Within Zambia these drivers vary across regions and include charcoal and wood fuel use, timber production, and unsustainable agriculture methods. Drivers of deforestation and forest degradation are influenced by a complex set of underlying causes that are primarily the result of past and current development processes. For a REDD+ project to be successful in Zambia, both the supply and demand for wood and non-wood forest products must be simultaneously addressed.

To ensure the success of REDD+ projects, interventions such as widespread knowledge about REDD+ and the development of incentives to adopt alternative livelihoods and energy sources are necessary. The success of REDD+ projects also depends on the large-scale engagement of stakeholders at all levels, but specifically at the community level, in order to ensure that communities receive tangible benefits from REDD+.

Source: UN-REDD/PB4/4ci/ENG

What is a REDD+ Project

BioCarbon Partners (BCP) enters into partnerships with landowners, governments and local communities to protect naturally forested landscapes in order to reduce deforestation, provide sustainable development solutions to local communities, and to conserve biodiversity.

- BCP seeks partnerships with governments and landowners in areas of conservation importance
- BCP seeks partnerships with local communities in and around these forested areas
- BCP invests in land management, community development projects and carbon verification
- **BCP does not work on plantations, nor seek title to land, nor forcibly displace anyone. Our mantra is 'socially responsible avoided deforestation' achieved through partnership.**



Appendix 4: Community REDD Illustrated Explanation

